



ICPSR 37679

Radicalization on the Internet: Virtual Extremism in the United States, 2015-2017

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Questionnaire for Online Extremism Survey
Data Wave 2



National Institute of Justice
Data Resources Program

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Extremism-2nd Wave

Hello, my name is Dr. Hawdon, and my colleagues and I are researching the expression of extremist and hateful opinions on the web. We would like to invite you to participate in our study. If you decide you want to be in the study, you will answer some questions on an online survey about your experiences online. We will ask if you have seen anything that expresses hateful or extremely negative attitudes towards people or groups. We are interested in seeing these materials relate to your other online activities and experiences. If you decide to take the survey, it will take you about six or seven minutes or so. The questions are not about sensitive topics, and there are no right or wrong answers. However, some questions will ask if you have seen or been a target of harassing materials online. It is alright for you to skip any question you do not want to answer. We believe that the research will help us understand how much hateful material is online and how these materials may influence you.

Other people will not know if you are in my study. I will put things I learn about you together with things I learn about other people between the ages of 15 and 35, so no one can tell what answers came from you. I will not know who you are, so no one will know how you answered the questions. Your parents or guardian has said it is alright for you to be in the study, and now you get to choose if you want to do it too. If you do not want to be in the study, that is fine. If you want to be in the study now and change your mind later, that is alright too. You can stop at any time, and you should only answer those questions you want to answer. My telephone number is 540-231-7476. You can call me if you have questions about the study. If you have questions or concerns regarding your rights as a research subject, please contact the Director of Research Compliance at (870) 972-2694.

If you decide to be in the study even though you know you do not have to, please continue by highlighting BEGIN SURVEY below. If you do not want to participate, please click on EXIT below. Highlight your choice and click on the arrows below.

- ☐ Begin survey (1)
- ☐ Exit (2)

Q1 Are you

- ☐ Male (1)
- ☐ Female (2)

Q2 In what year were you born?

Q3 Were you born in the U.S.?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q4 Were either of your parents born outside the U.S.?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q5 How would you describe where you live?

- ☐ a large city (over 250,000) (1)
- ☐ a medium-size city (50,000-250,000) (2)
- ☐ a small city or town (Under 50,000) (3)
- ☐ a suburb near a city (4)
- ☐ open country or a rural area (5)

Q6 Are you currently:

- ☐ Living alone (1)
- ☐ Married or living with a partner, no children in the home (2)
- ☐ Single parent (3)
- ☐ Married or living with a partner, children in the home (4)
- ☐ Living with parents (5)
- ☐ Other family type (e.g. living with roommates) (6)

Q7 Which is the highest level of education you have achieved?

- ☐ Less than a High School diploma (1)
- ☐ High School Degree (2)
- ☐ Some college (3)
- ☐ A college degree (4)
- ☐ A master's degree, professional degree or higher (5)

Q8 What is your main occupation? Select all that apply.

- ☐ I'm in school (1)
- ☐ I'm in a paid, full-time job (2)
- ☐ I'm in a paid, part-time job (3)
- ☐ I'm unemployed/ looking for a job (4)
- ☐ I'm unemployed/ not looking for a job (5)

Q9 What is your race? Select all that apply.

- ☐ White (1)
- ☐ Black or African American (2)
- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native (3)
- ☐ Asian Indian (4)
- ☐ Chinese (5)
- ☐ Filipino (6)
- ☐ Japanese (7)
- ☐ Korean (8)
- ☐ Vietnamese (9)
- ☐ Other Asian (10)
- ☐ Native Hawaiian (11)
- ☐ Guamanian or Chamorro (12)
- ☐ Samoan (13)
- ☐ Other Pacific Islander (14)
- ☐ Other Race (15)
- ☐ Prefer not to answer (16)

Q10 In the past 3 months, which of the following services have you used? Choose all that apply.

- ☐ Facebook (1)
- ☐ YouTube (2)
- ☐ Instagram (3)
- ☐ Twitter (4)
- ☐ Google+ (5)
- ☐ MySpace (6)
- ☐ Wikipedia (7)
- ☐ Tumblr (8)
- ☐ Pinterest (9)
- ☐ Snapchat (10)
- ☐ Newspaper message boards (11)
- ☐ General message boards (12)
- ☐ Image boards (e.g. 4chan) (13)
- ☐ Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live messenger) (14)
- ☐ Online role-playing games or MMO (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape, etc.) (15)
- ☐ First-person shooter games or FPS (e.g. Call of Duty, Battlefield, etc.) (16)
- ☐ Dating services (eHarmony, Match, Kik, Tinder, etc.) (17)
- ☐ Blogs or Forums (18)
- ☐ Email (19)
- ☐ Skype (20)
- ☐ Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P, YikYak) (21)
- ☐ Reddit (22)

Q11 Approximately how many hours per day do you use the Internet?

- ☐ Less than one hour per day (1)
- ☐ One or two hours per day (2)
- ☐ Three to five hours per day (3)
- ☐ Six to seven hours per day (4)
- ☐ Eight to nine hours per day (5)
- ☐ Ten or more hours per day (6)

Q12 In the past 3 months, have you seen hateful or degrading writings or speech online that attacked certain groups of people or individuals?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q13 In the past 3 months, have you seen or heard any materials online that expressed negative views about any group because of the group's race, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender, gender identity, political views, immigrant status, or religion?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

If No Is Selected, Then Skip To How frequently do you see material on...

Q14 Thinking of the most recent time when you saw or heard negative views expressed about a group, how would you best describe those views? (check all that apply)

- ☐ They advocated violence against the group (1)
- ☐ They used stereotypes to describe the group (2)
- ☐ They blamed the group for their problems (3)
- ☐ They blamed the group for the nation's problems (4)
- ☐ They advocated hatred of the group (5)
- ☐ They called for others to discriminate against the group (6)

Q15 Did the negative views that you saw or heard online pertain to one or more of the following? (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Ethnicity or race (1)
- ☐ Nationality or immigrant status (2)
- ☐ Sexual orientation (3)
- ☐ Religious conviction/belief (4)
- ☐ Political Views (5)
- ☐ Disability (6)
- ☐ Sex/Gender/Gender Identity (7)
- ☐ Appearance (8)
- ☐ Other (9) _____

Q16 Please indicate which of the following services you saw or heard negative views. Choose all that apply.

- ☐ Facebook (1)
- ☐ YouTube (2)
- ☐ Instagram (3)
- ☐ Twitter (4)
- ☐ Google+ (5)
- ☐ MySpace (6)
- ☐ Wikipedia (7)
- ☐ Tumblr (8)
- ☐ Pinterest (9)
- ☐ Snapchat (10)
- ☐ Newspaper message boards (11)
- ☐ General message boards (12)
- ☐ Image boards (e.g. 4chan) (13)
- ☐ Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live messenger) (14)
- ☐ Online role-playing games or MMO (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape, etc.) (15)
- ☐ First-person shooter games or FPS (e.g. Call of Duty, Battlefield, etc.) (16)
- ☐ Dating services (eHarmony, Match, Kik, Tinder, etc.) (17)
- ☐ Blogs or Forums (18)
- ☐ Email (19)
- ☐ Skype (20)
- ☐ Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P, YikYak) (21)
- ☐ Reddit (22)

Q17 How did you end up on this site?

- ☐ I deliberately found my way (1)
- ☐ I got the link to the site from a friend or acquaintance of mine (2)
- ☐ I got there by accident (3)

Q18 In your opinion, how disturbing was this material? Please assess on a scale from 1–5, when 1 = extremely disturbing and 5= not at all disturbing.

- ☐ 1= Extremely disturbing (1)
- ☐ 2= very disturbing (2)
- ☐ 3= disturbing (3)
- ☐ 4= only slightly disturbing (4)
- ☐ 5= Not at all disturbing (5)

Q19 How frequently do you see material online that expresses negative views toward some group?

- ☐ I never see this type of material (1)
- ☐ I see this type of material very infrequently (2)
- ☐ I see this type of material occasionally (3)
- ☐ I see this type of material frequently (4)

Q20a Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online? Yes Is Selected

Q20b Thinking of the last time you were targeted, to which of the following did the hateful or degrading material that targeted you pertain? Choose all relevant options.

- ☐ Ethnicity or race (1)
- ☐ Nationality (2)
- ☐ Sexual orientation (3)
- ☐ Religious conviction/beliefs (4)
- ☐ Political views (5)
- ☐ Disability (6)
- ☐ Sex/Gender/Gender Identity (7)
- ☐ Appearance (8)
- ☐ Other (9)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online? Yes Is Selected

Q20c When was the most recent time that you were personally the target of hateful or degrading material online?

- ☐ Within the last 3 months (1)
- ☐ 3 months to a year ago (2)
- ☐ More than a year ago (3)

Q21 How often do you see people using language, images or humor on social networking sites that you find offensive?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q22 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you tell the person who is being offensive to stop?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q23 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you defend the person or group being attacked?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q24 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you ignore what is being said?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q25 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you join in the mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q26 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others told the person who is being offensive to stop?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q27 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others defended the person or group being attacked?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q28 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others joined in the mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q29 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have site administrators deleted their offensive comments or otherwise halted their mean or offensive behavior?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q30 When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have you seen others persuade those who post the material to stop being mean or offensive?

- ☐ Never (1)
- ☐ Only once in a while (2)
- ☐ Sometimes (3)
- ☐ Frequently (4)

Q31 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1–10, where 1 = not very true of me, and 10 = very true of me.

[illegible]

Q32 Please answer the following question using a scale of 1 – 5, where 1 = not wrong at all, and 5 = extremely wrong. How wrong is it for people to....

	1= not wrong at all (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5= extremely wrong (5)
Cheat on their taxes (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cheat on their spouse or partner (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q33 Please respond to the following statement using a scale of 1 – 5, where 1 = strongly disagree, and 5 = strongly agree.

	1= strongly disagree (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5= Strongly agree (5)
Laws are made to be broken. (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is okay to do anything you want as long as you don't hurt anyone. (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fighting between friends or within families is nobody else's business. (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q34 Would you say that the following people can be trusted, or that you can't be too careful in dealing with these people? Assess on a scale from 1–10, where 1 = you can't be too careful and 10 = can be fully trusted

	1= you can't be too careful (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5 (5)	6 (6)	7 (7)	8 (8)	9 (9)	10= can be fully trusted (10)
People in general (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People met only online (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Politicians (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The police (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business leaders (5)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q35 How many friends or followers do you have on social networking or media sites, such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, etc.

- ☐ None (1)
- ☐ 1-100 (2)
- ☐ 101-500 (3)
- ☐ 501-1000 (4)
- ☐ 1001-1500 (5)
- ☐ 1501-2000 (6)
- ☐ 2001-2500 (7)
- ☐ 2501 or more (8)

Q36 How many people do you follow on the social networking or media sites, such as Facebook, Twitter, or Instagram, etc.

- ☐ None (1)
- ☐ 1-100 (2)
- ☐ 101-500 (3)
- ☐ 501-1000 (7)
- ☐ 1001-1500 (4)
- ☐ 1501-2000 (5)
- ☐ 2001-2500 (6)
- ☐ 2501 or more (8)

Q37 How many close friends do you interact with only online?

- ☐ Almost none of them (1)
- ☐ A few, but most of my close friends I also see offline (2)
- ☐ Most of my close friends I only see online, but I do have close offline friends (3)
- ☐ Almost all of my close friends are online friends (4)

Q38 How close do you feel to each of the following? Please indicate on a scale from 1 to 5 where 1 = not at all close and 5 = very close

	1= Not at all close (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5= Very close (5)	Not applicable (6)
Your family (1)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Your friends (2)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
An online community to which you belong (3)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
A religious community (4)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Q39 How important is religion in your life?

- ☐ 1= Not at all important (1)
- ☐ 2 (2)
- ☐ 3 (3)
- ☐ 4 (4)
- ☐ 5= Very important (5)
- ☐ Not applicable (6)

Q40 What religion do you most align with?

- ☐ None (1)
- ☐ Protestant Christian (2)
- ☐ Catholicism (3)
- ☐ Judaism (4)
- ☐ Islam (5)
- ☐ Buddhism (6)
- ☐ Hinduism (7)
- ☐ Other (8)

Q41 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1-10, where 1= not at all and 10= completely. Do conventional religious institutions meet your religious and spiritual needs?

- ☐ 1= Not at all (1)
- ☐ 2 (2)
- ☐ 3 (3)
- ☐ 4 (4)
- ☐ 5 (5)
- ☐ 6 (6)
- ☐ 7 (7)
- ☐ 8 (8)
- ☐ 9 (9)
- ☐ 10= Completely (10)

Q42 How satisfied are you with the way things are going in the United States right now?

- ☐ Completely dissatisfied (1)
- ☐ Mostly dissatisfied (2)
- ☐ Somewhat dissatisfied (3)
- ☐ Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied (4)
- ☐ Somewhat satisfied (5)
- ☐ Mostly satisfied (6)
- ☐ Completely satisfied (7)

Q43 Please answer the following question using a scale from 1-10, where 1= not at all and 10= completely. How well do you think major political parties protect what is important to you?

- ☐ 1= not at all (1)
- ☐ 2 (2)
- ☐ 3 (3)
- ☐ 4 (4)
- ☐ 5 (5)
- ☐ 6 (6)
- ☐ 7 (7)
- ☐ 8 (8)
- ☐ 9 (9)
- ☐ 10= completely (10)

Q44 On a scale of 1 to 7, how would you rank your political views?

- ☐ 1= Extremely Liberal (1)
- ☐ 2= Liberal (2)
- ☐ 3= Slightly Liberal (3)
- ☐ 4= Moderate (4)
- ☐ 5= Slightly Conservative (5)
- ☐ 6= Conservative (6)
- ☐ 7= Extremely conservative (7)
- ☐ 8= Don't Know (8)

Q45a Have you expressed political views on the Internet in the past year?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you expressed political views on the internet in the past year? Yes Is Selected

Q45b Would you do it again?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you expressed political views on the internet in the past year? Yes Is Selected

Q45c Please share these political views you expressed online.

Q46a Have you ever produced online material that other people would likely interpret as hateful or degrading?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever produced online material that other people would likely interpret as hateful or degrading? Yes Is Selected

Q46b Are you a member of a group that produces online material that other people often interpret as hateful or degrading?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Are you a member of a group that produces online material that other people often interpret as hateful or degrading? Yes Is Selected

Q46c What is the name of this group?

Q47a Have you ever participated in a protest event (sit-in, rally or march, petition singing, boycott, demonstration, etc) in the past year?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever participated in a protest event (sit-in, rally or march, petition singing, boycott, demonstration, etc) in the past year? Yes Is Selected

Q47b Did you participate online, offline or both?

- ☐ Online (1)
- ☐ Offline (2)
- ☐ Both (3)

Display This Question:

If Have you ever participated in a protest event (sit-in, rally or march, petition singing, boycott, demonstration, etc) in the past year? Yes Is Selected

Q47c What were you protesting?

Q48a In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Display This Question:

If In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime? Yes Is Selected

Q48b How long ago were you the target/victim of an online crime?

- ☐ Within the last three months (1)
- ☐ 3 months to a year ago (2)
- ☐ More than a year ago (3)

Display This Question:

If In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime? Yes Is Selected

Q48c Which crime was this?

- ☐ Slander or defamation of your character (1)
- ☐ Coercion or a threat of violence (2)
- ☐ Identity theft (3)
- ☐ Fraud (4)
- ☐ Sexual harassment (5)
- ☐ Other (6)

Display This Question:

If Which crime was this? Other Is Selected

Q48d What crime?

Q49 Below you can give feedback to the authors of the questionnaire. Were any questions ambiguous or hard to understand? Did you feel like some important answer options were missing? All feedback is very welcome!